

■ resolve~S.O.S.

BIOS update utility. You need only run this program once. This utility will load the correct data file for the steppings of the processor so that the correct data file is available. If you do not have access to the Update utility program, then it is possible to update your system BIOS from the Asus site (www.asus.com).

Applications

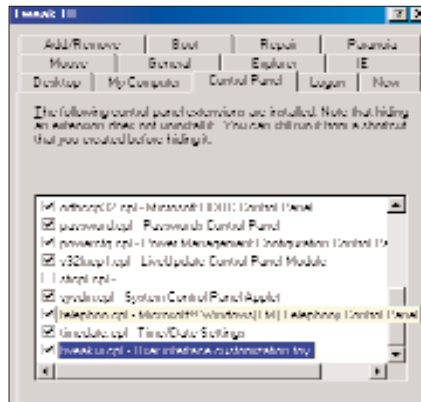
+ No icon, no access!

I downloaded and installed TweakUI from download.com. It was working nicely till I removed its icon from the Control Panel. Now, since there is no TweakUI icon in Control Panel, I can't run it, nor can I do or undo any changes, as I just don't have access to it. Uninstalling and reinstalling did not work.

Donnir,
via e-mail

R Icons in Control Panel are controlled by the .cpl files. TweakUI allows you to hide these icons from the Control Panel. The problem is that it does not prevent you from hiding its own icon.

However, here's what you can do to fix this problem. Go to Start > Find > Files and Folders. Here, enter *.cpl and click OK. You should get a list of cpl files. Find TweakUI and right-click it. You should find an option, 'Open With Control Panel'. Selecting this option will open TweakUI. Then click on the Control Panel tab and click on the TweakUI checkbox. This should solve the problem.



Check the TweakUI box to make it show up in Control Panel

Windows

+ Wipeouts

Windows Me has an excellent facility called System Restore. However, when I opt to restore my system to any previous date, the computer wipes out any programs or applications that might have been installed after the restore date. Is there any way to disable this wiping out of applications installed after the 'restore date'?

Doc Lawrence,
via e-mail

R The System Restore feature actually restores the system to the last snapshot taken by Windows Me. It deliberately does not install the applications that were installed after this time, because they might have caused the system to crash. Windows Me takes these snapshots at some intervals, or at the time specified by

the user.

You can disable the option completely, but there is no way you can disable it from only wiping off the applications. However, here is what you can do. You can get Windows Me to take a snapshot of the system just before you install an application, and if it works fine, take another one after the installation.

Internet and communications

+ Modem queries

I have a 28.8 Kbps internal modem. When I double-click on 'modem' in the system tray to see its data transfer rate, it gives the number of bits or bytes received and sent. My questions are as follows:

1. When I am browsing any site without sending any data to it, the modem lights still blink, indicating some bytes are being sent. Please tell me what this information is about?

2. Though the maximum speed of the modem is 28.8 Kbps, sometimes the data transfer rate is large such that it reaches 11500 bps (that is 11.5 Kbps) and sometimes as low as 2 Kbps. How is this possible?

Manty,
via e-mail

R The modem light blinks as there is some data transfer that is taking place on your machine. If the page you are browsing contains ads that change dynamically, data transfer takes place when these ads load.

This could also be due to an instant messenger that is running, a download in progress, or even some backdoor or a virus. You can use the command, netstat, in DOS to check what ports are being used in your machine.

Secondly, you have the data transfer rate wrong as you are mistaken between the bauds, bits and bytes of the modem. Your modem speed could either be said to be 28.8 kilo bauds per second or 28.8 kilo-bits per second.

A baud is the number of signalling elements that occur each second. This is approximately equal to the number of bits per second. Now, 1 kilobit in communication terms would be 1024 bits (2^{10}), while a byte equals 8 bits.

Your data transfer speed reaches speeds of 11500 bits per second, that is 11.5 Kbps to 2 Kilobytes per second, which translates as 16 Kbps. Hence, the data transfer that is taking place is not from a minimum of 2 Kbps to 11.5 Kbps, but from a minimum of around 11 Kbps to a maximum of 16 Kbps.

Windows Unsent mail

I am unable to send any messages through Outlook Express. My default mail handler is cal2.vsnl.net.in. I receive the following error message, 'The message could not be sent because one of the recipients was rejected by the server. Subject', Account: 'cal2.vsnl.net.in', Server: 'cal2.vsnl.net.in', Protocol: SMTP, Server Response: '550 <my_email_address>... Relaying denied', Port: 25, Secure(SSL): No, Server Error: 550, Error Number: 0x800CCC79'.

A.G. Krishnan,
via e-mail

R This error, which is usually random, means that your SMTP server is checking whether the recipient name actually exists before sending your mail. If the recipient's mail

server is down or unavailable for some reason, your SMTP server cannot verify the address and may reject the relay. If this is the case, the message will be sent when the receiving server is again available. You actually cannot do anything about the error as this is usually a problem with the ISP.

